

CG Shift Calculation

Preliminary ARG27 longitudinal CG shift from the accumulator and inverter changes

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PRELIMINARY The ARG27 accumulator and inverter CAD were not built or placeable in the car at the time of this calculation, so their ARG27 positions are estimates. See the assumptions.

1 Context

For ARG27, the accumulator and inverter are being moved and both are getting lighter. We design the car to a 50/50 weight distribution, so if the longitudinal (front to rear) CG moves, we may have to shift the wheelbase to bring it back. This page calculates a preliminary estimate of that longitudinal CG shift.

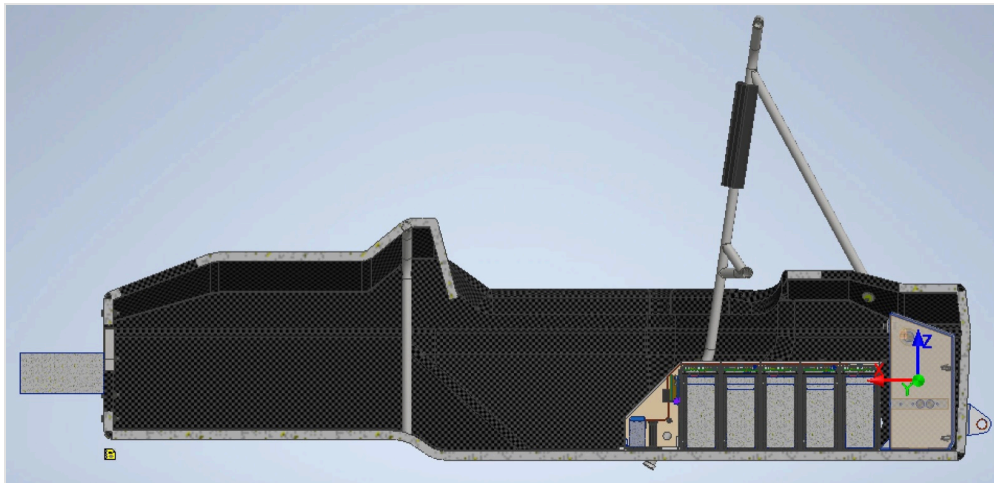


FIGURE 1 ARG26 packaging, side view.

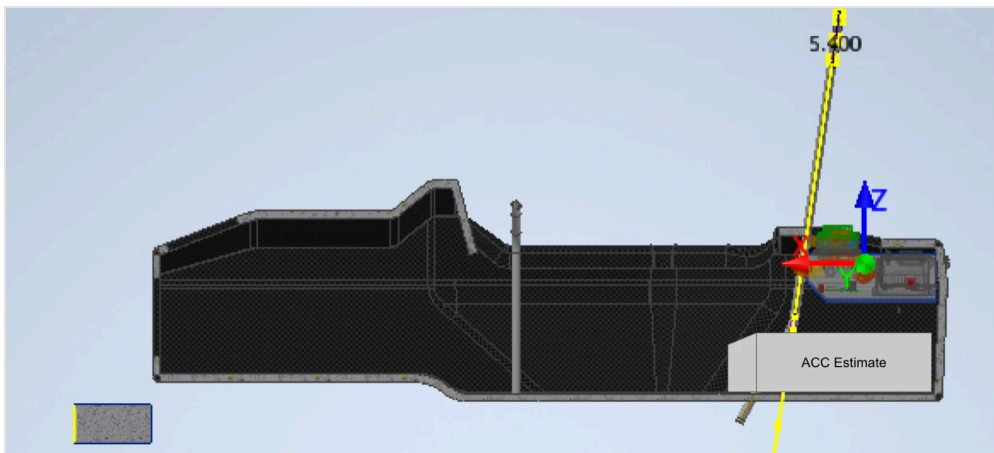


FIGURE 2 Preliminary ARG27 packaging, side view, with the accumulator shown as an estimate.

2 Methodology

Positions are x in vehicle coordinates, in inches, with $+x$ pointing forward. All masses are sprung masses, so the ARG26 total (m_{26}) is the total sprung mass of the car with the driver and x_{26} is its sprung CG.

2.1 Assumptions

- This calculation is preliminary. The ARG27 accumulator and inverter CAD were not built or placeable in the car at the time, so the ARG27 positions come from hand estimates instead of CAD.
- The accumulator CG shift can be modeled with a rectangular analysis. The accumulator is treated as a rectangle with its CG in the middle. Its front face stays in the same place and the case grows rearward to within 50 mm of the monocoque rear inner face, so its CG moves back by half the added length.
- The ARG27 inverter enclosure is a $13.5 \times 10 \times 5$ in box sitting flush against the monocoque rear inner face. It has a 60% rearward weight bias, meaning 60% of its weight is in the rear part, so its CG sits 40% of its 13.5 in length from the rear face.
- The ARG27 accumulator and inverter masses are estimates.
- Everything other than the accumulator and inverter is lumped together as "other" and is the same on both cars.

2.2 Remove the ARG26 Accumulator and Inverter

$$m_{\text{other}} = m_{26} - m_{\text{ACC26}} - m_{\text{INV26}}$$

$$x_{\text{other}} = (m_{26} x_{26} - m_{\text{ACC26}} x_{\text{ACC26}} - m_{\text{INV26}} x_{\text{INV26}}) / m_{\text{other}}$$

2.3 Add the ARG27 Accumulator and Inverter

$$m_{27} = m_{\text{other}} + m_{\text{ACC27}} + m_{\text{INV27}}$$

$$x_{27} = (m_{\text{other}} x_{\text{other}} + m_{\text{ACC27}} x_{\text{ACC27}} + m_{\text{INV27}} x_{\text{INV27}}) / m_{27}$$

2.4 Longitudinal CG Shift

$$\Delta x_{\text{CG}} = x_{27} - x_{26}$$

A positive shift means the CG moved forward.

2.5 Effect on Weight Distribution

With wheelbase L , the shift moves this much of the weight onto the front axle:

$$\Delta(\text{front \%}) = 100 \times \Delta x_{\text{CG}} / L$$

3 Results

3.1 Inputs

Part	Mass (lb)	x (in)
ARG26 sprung mass with driver	470	-50.79
ACC26 (accumulator)	102	-64.00
INV26 (inverter)	34.17	-78.20
ACC27 (accumulator)	95	-66.64
INV27 (inverter)	15	-76.28

The ARG27 accumulator CG moves 2.64 in toward the rear, from $x = -64.00$ in to $x = -66.64$ in, because the case grows rearward into the space behind it. The ARG27 inverter sits flush against the monocoque rear inner face with its CG at $x = -76.28$ in, 1.92 in forward of the ARG26 inverter. See the appendix for where each input comes from.

3.2 Change in Each Part

Part	Mass removed (lb)	x shift (in), + is forward
Accumulator	7.00	-2.64
Inverter	19.17	+1.92
Total	26.17	

3.3 Calculation

Step 1, everything else on the car:

$$m_{\text{other}} = 470 - 102 - 34.17 = 333.83 \text{ lb}$$

$$x_{\text{other}} = (470(-50.789) - 102(-64) - 34.17(-78.2)) / 333.83 = -43.947 \text{ in}$$

Step 2, ARG27:

$$m_{27} = 333.83 + 95 + 15 = 443.83 \text{ lb}$$

$$x_{27} = (333.83(-43.947) + 95(-66.64) + 15(-76.28)) / 443.83 = -49.897 \text{ in}$$

Step 3, CG shift:

$$\Delta x_{\text{CG}} = -49.897 - (-50.789) = +0.89 \text{ in}$$

The longitudinal CG moves 0.89 in forward. Moving the accumulator back pulls the CG rearward, but moving the inverter forward and taking 26.2 lb out of the two parts, which both sit behind the CG, has a bigger effect and pushes it forward.

3.4 Effect on Weight Distribution

With the ARG26 wheelbase of 61 in, a 0.89 in forward shift moves about 1.5% of the weight onto the front axle:

$$\Delta(\text{front } \%) = 100 \times 0.89 / 61 = 1.5\%$$

So a car that was 50/50 would become about 51.5/48.5 front to rear.

4 Error Sensitivity

The ARG27 masses and positions are estimates, so this section shows how much the CG shift changes if one of them is off. Each chart varies one input and keeps the others at their nominal values. All four charts use the same vertical scale, so a steeper line means the result depends more on that input. The nominal CG shift is +0.89 in. The right axis reads the same CG shift as the change in front weight percentage from section 3.4: $\Delta(\text{front } \%) = 100 \times \Delta x_{\text{CG}} / 61$.

Input	Error range	CG shift range	Change in CG shift
ACC27 mass	-10 to +10 lb	+0.52 to +1.28 in	-0.038 in per lb
ACC27 CG, x	-2 to +2 in	+0.46 to +1.32 in	+0.214 in per in
INV27 mass	-5 to +5 lb	+0.60 to +1.19 in	-0.059 in per lb
INV27 CG, x	-2 to +2 in	+0.82 to +0.96 in	+0.034 in per in

The slopes in the last column come from differentiating the ARG27 CG equation. For a part i , the accumulator or the inverter, moving its CG by 1 in moves the car's CG by its share of the total mass, and adding 1 lb pulls the car's CG toward that part by its distance from the CG divided by the total mass:

$$\partial \Delta x_{\text{CG}} / \partial x_i = m_i / m_{27}$$

$$\partial \Delta x_{\text{CG}} / \partial m_i = (x_i - x_{27}) / m_{27}$$

With $m_{27} = 443.83$ lb and $x_{27} = -49.897$ in:

- ACC27 CG, x: $95 / 443.83 = +0.214$ in per in
- ACC27 mass: $(-66.64 - (-49.897)) / 443.83 = -0.038$ in per lb
- INV27 CG, x: $15.00 / 443.83 = +0.034$ in per in
- INV27 mass: $(-76.28 - (-49.897)) / 443.83 = -0.059$ in per lb

The position lines are straight. The mass lines curve slightly because the mass also appears in m_{27} , so their slope is given at the nominal mass.

The accumulator CG position matters most: every inch it is off changes the CG shift by about 0.21 in. The inverter CG position matters least. Going from a 50% to a 70% rearward weight bias only moves the CG shift between +0.85 and +0.94 in.

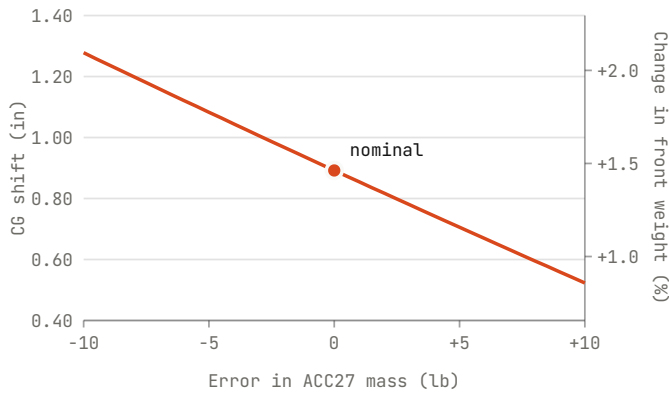


CHART 1 ACC27 mass, nominal 95 lb.

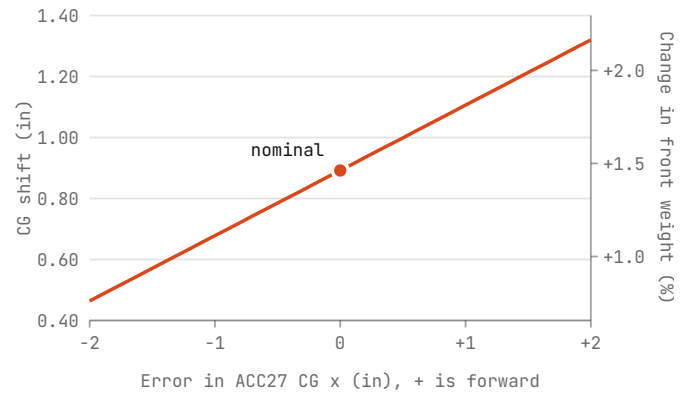


CHART 2 ACC27 CG x, nominal -66.64 in.

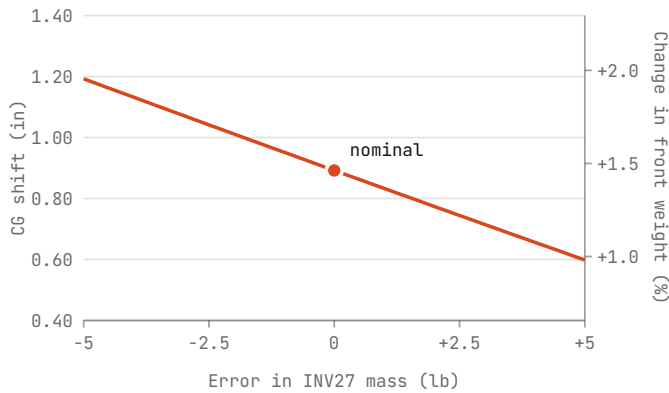


CHART 3 INV27 mass, nominal 15 lb.

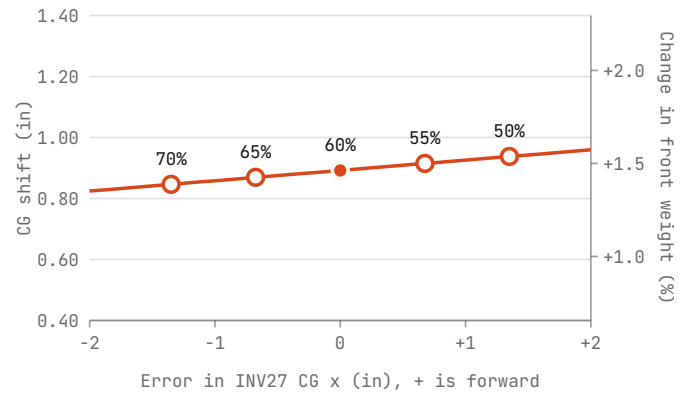


CHART 4 INV27 CG x, nominal -76.28 in. Labels mark the CG for rearward weight biases of 70% to 50%; 60% is nominal.

5 Remedy: Moving the Axles

For 50/50, the CG has to sit at the midpoint between the front and rear axles. Since the CG moves forward 0.89 in, we move both the front and rear axles forward 0.89 in. The midpoint moves with them, the car goes back to 50/50, and the wheelbase stays at 61 in.

A Appendix: Input Sources

Input	Value	Source
ARG26 sprung mass with driver	470 lb	Sprung mass without the driver, 320 lb, plus a driver weight of 150 lb.
ARG26 sprung CG, x	-50.79 in	The car is designed to 50/50, so the CG is half the wheelbase behind the front axle: $-20.289 - 61 \times 0.5 = -50.789$. Front axle location from CAD (Figure 3).
ACC26 mass	102 lb	ARG26 weight budget, accumulator current weight of 46.266 kg (Figure 12).
ACC26 CG, x	-64.00 in	iProperties of the accumulator master assembly in CAD, -1625.284 mm (Figure 4).
INV26 mass	34.17 lb	ARG26 weight budget, inverter current weight of 15.5 kg (Figure 13).
INV26 CG, x	-78.20 in	iProperties of the inverter enclosure assembly in CAD (Figure 5).
ACC27 mass	95 lb	Estimate from Aryaman (HV lead).
ACC27 CG, x	-66.64 in	Rectangular approximation of the accumulator. The front face stays in place and the case grows rearward into the 7.25 in gap between the ARG26 accumulator and the monocoque rear inner face (Figure 7), leaving 50 mm of clearance: $7.25 \text{ in} - 50 \text{ mm} = 5.28 \text{ in}$ (134.15 mm), close to the estimated 130 mm size change. The CG moves back by half of that, -2.64 in, from the ACC26 CG (Figure 6).
INV27 mass	15 lb	Estimate of 15 lb for the new inverter.
INV27 CG, x	-76.28 in	ARG27 inverter enclosure is $13.5 \times 10 \times 5$ in (Figure 10, Figure 11), assumed flush to the monocoque rear inner face at $x = -81.676$ in (Figure 9). With a 60% rearward weight bias, the CG is $13.5 - (13.5)(0.6) = 5.4$ in forward of the rear face: $-81.676 + 5.4 = -76.28$ in (Figure 8).
Wheelbase, L	61 in	From our design. Kept the same on ARG27.

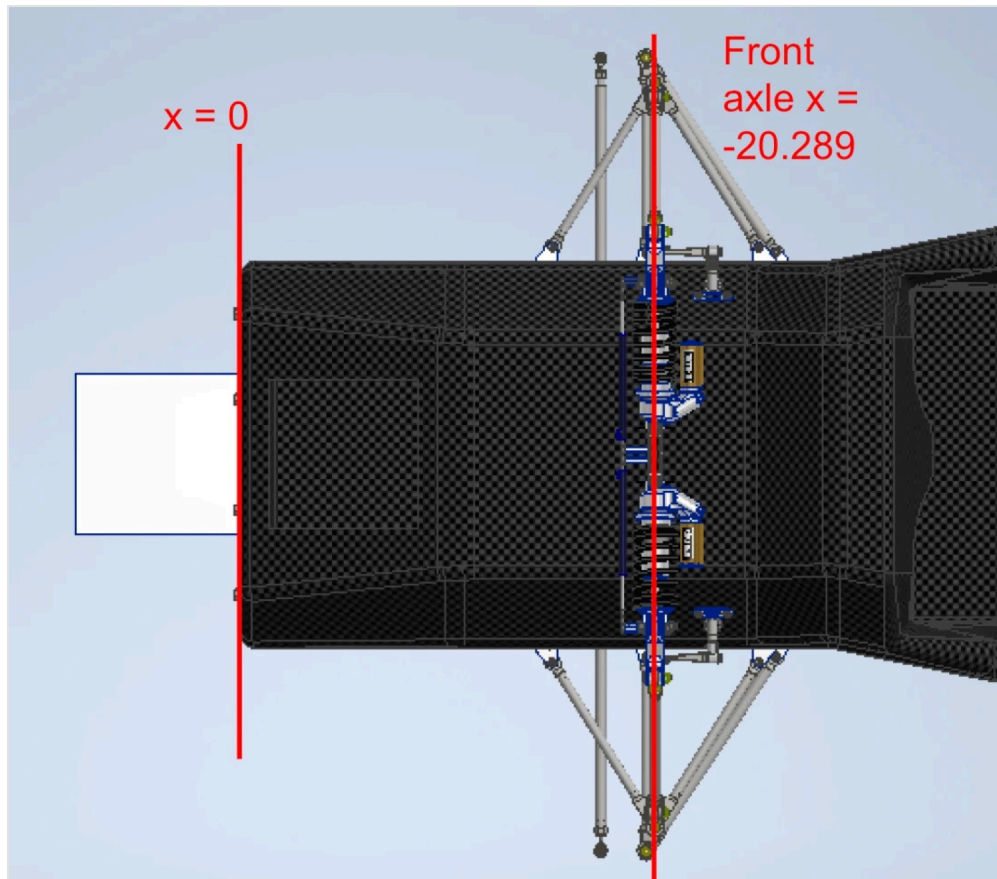


FIGURE 3 ARG26 front axle location in CAD, $x = -20.289$ in.

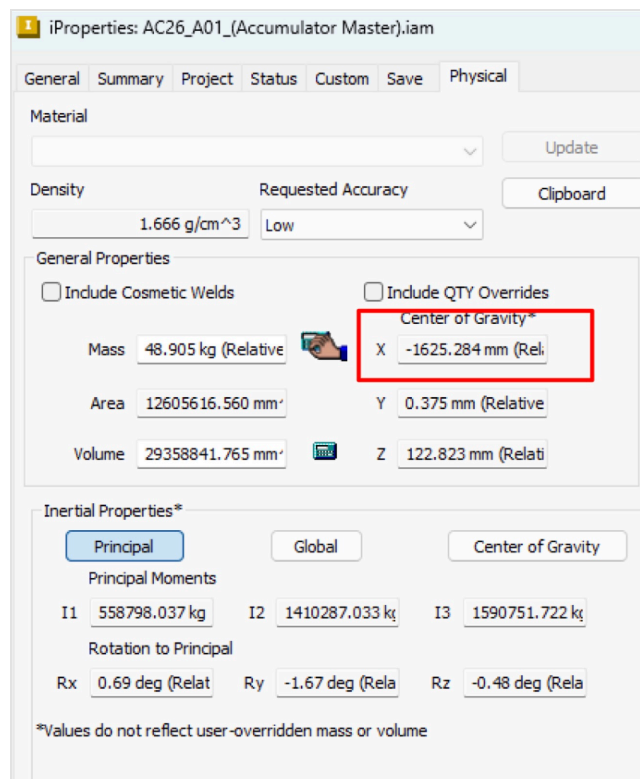


FIGURE 4 iProperties of the ARG26 accumulator master assembly, CG $x = -1625.284$ mm (-64.00 in).

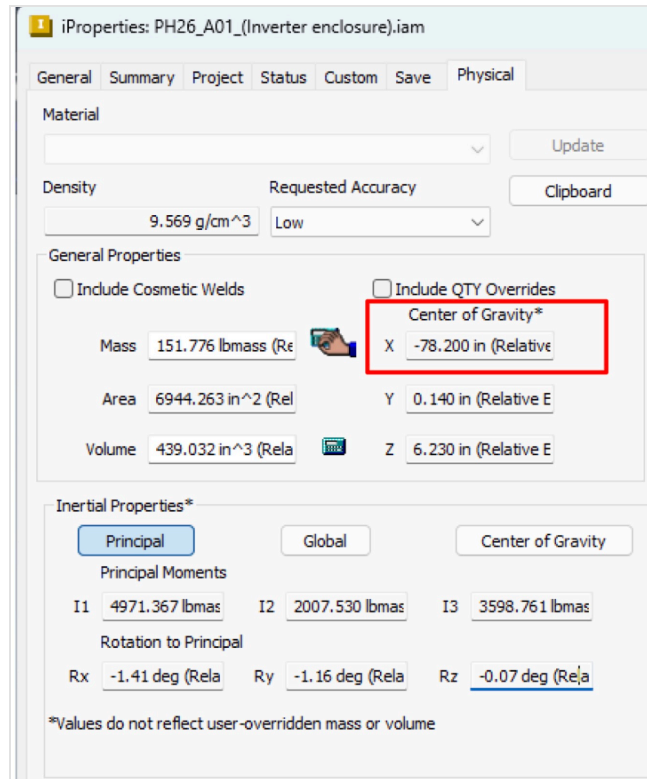


FIGURE 5 iProperties of the ARG26 inverter enclosure assembly, CG x = -78.20 in.

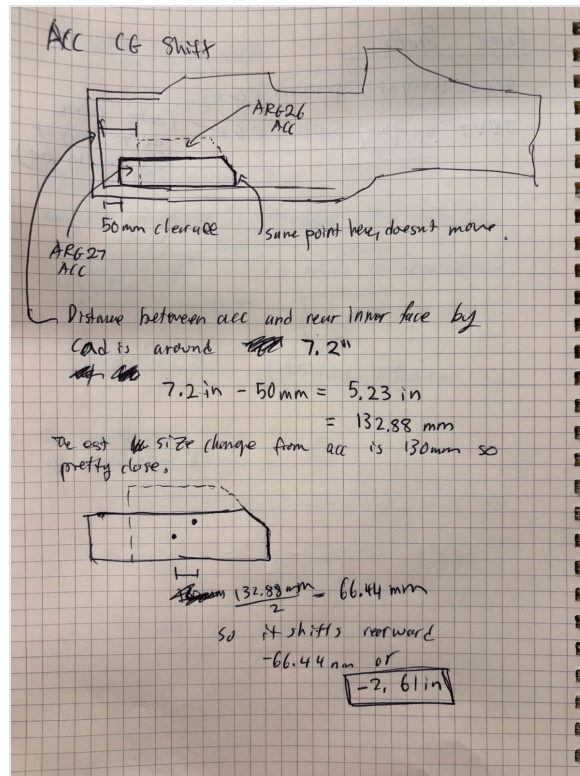


FIGURE 6 Hand calculation of the ACC27 CG shift. The accumulator grows rearward to within 50 mm of the rear inner face, so its CG moves back half the added length. The sketch uses 7.2 in; the results use the CAD measurement of 7.25 in (Figure 7), which gives -2.64 in.

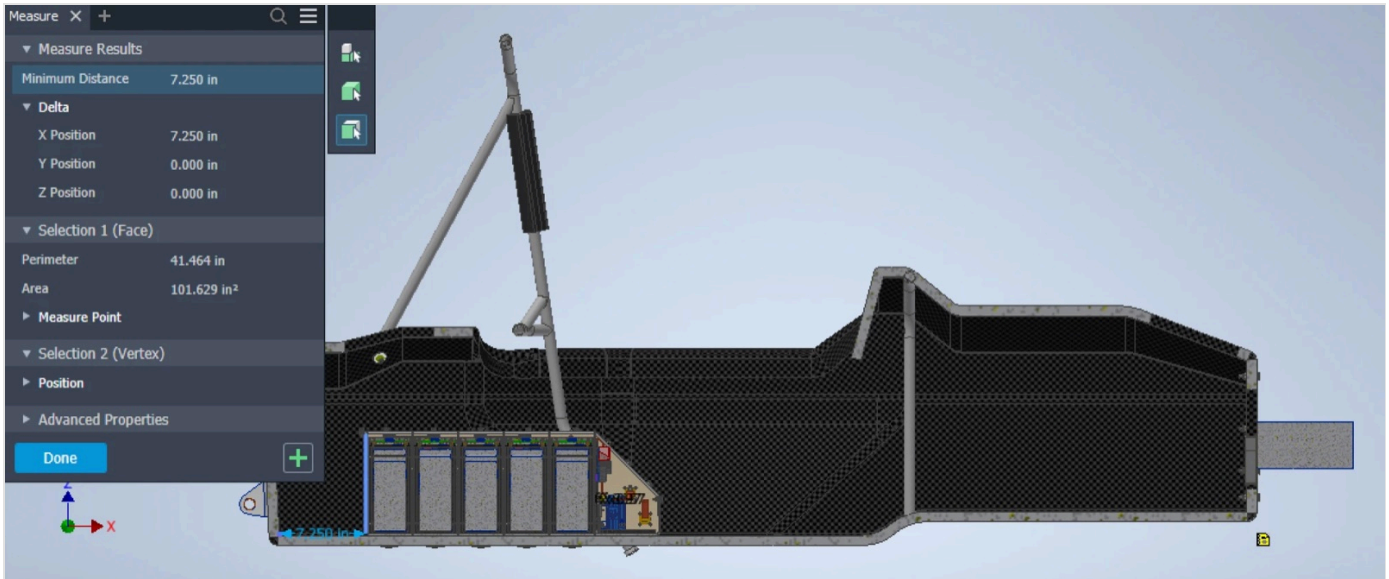


FIGURE 7 Distance between the ARG26 accumulator and the monocoque rear inner face measured in CAD, 7.25 in.

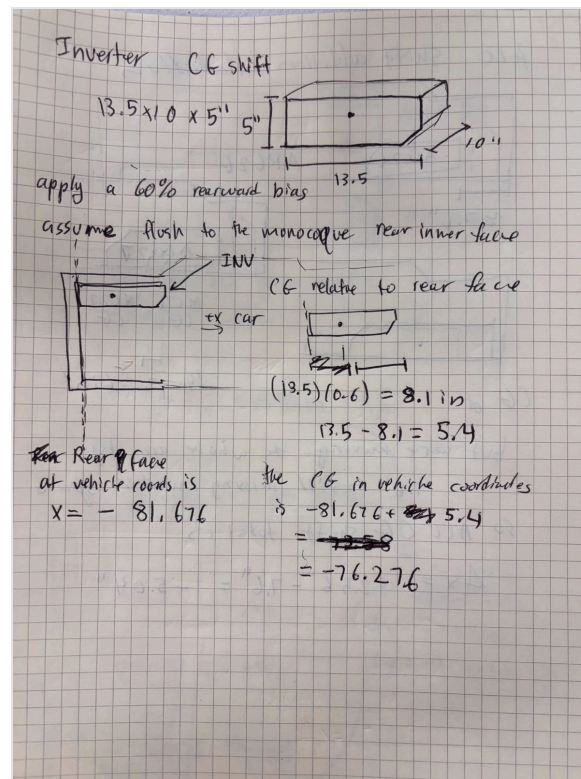


FIGURE 8 Hand calculation of the INV27 CG. The enclosure sits flush to the monocoque rear inner face with a 60% rearward bias, so its CG is 5.4 in forward of it, $x = -76.28$ in.

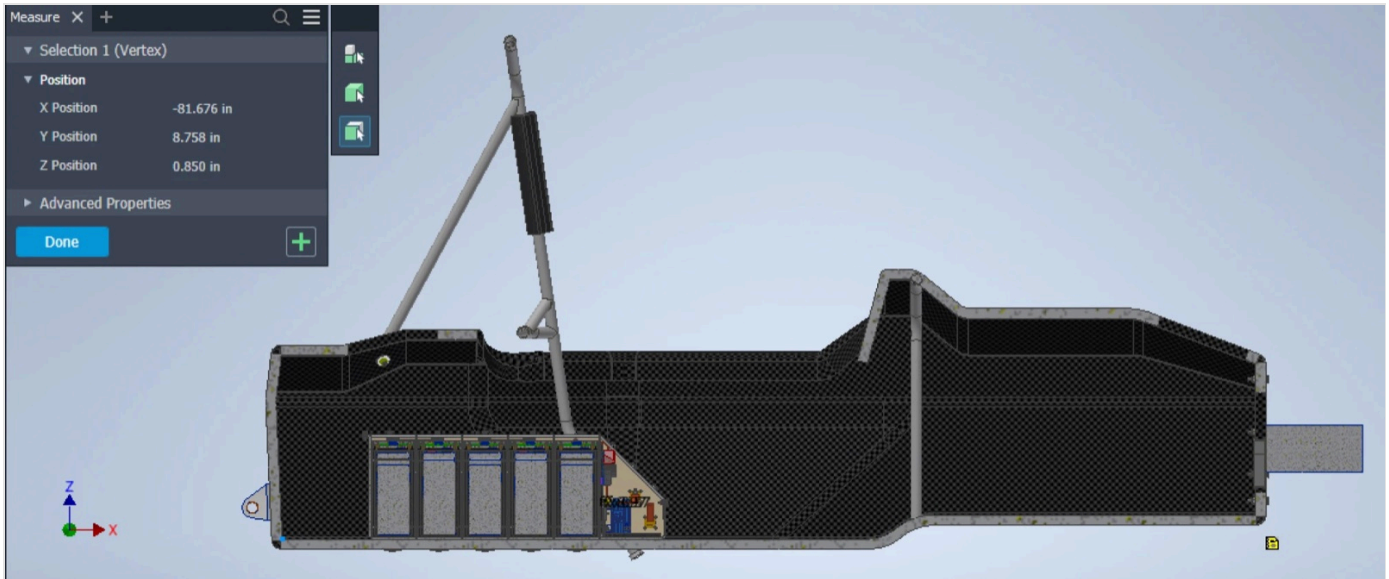
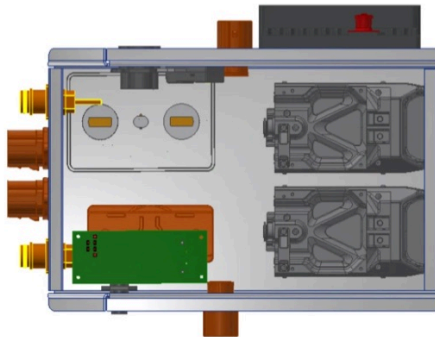
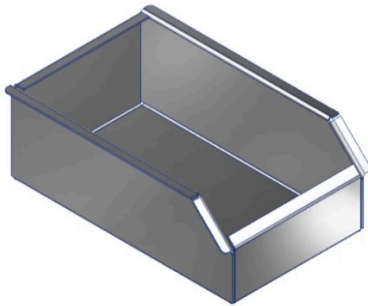


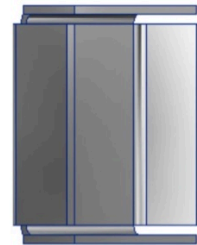
FIGURE 9 Monocoque rear inner face location in CAD, $x = -81.676$ in.

Design

- major changes:
 - AMK $\rightarrow$ DTL sizing changes
 - addition of discharge board, current shunt
 - connector layout



mounting:
tension bracket (like ARG25)



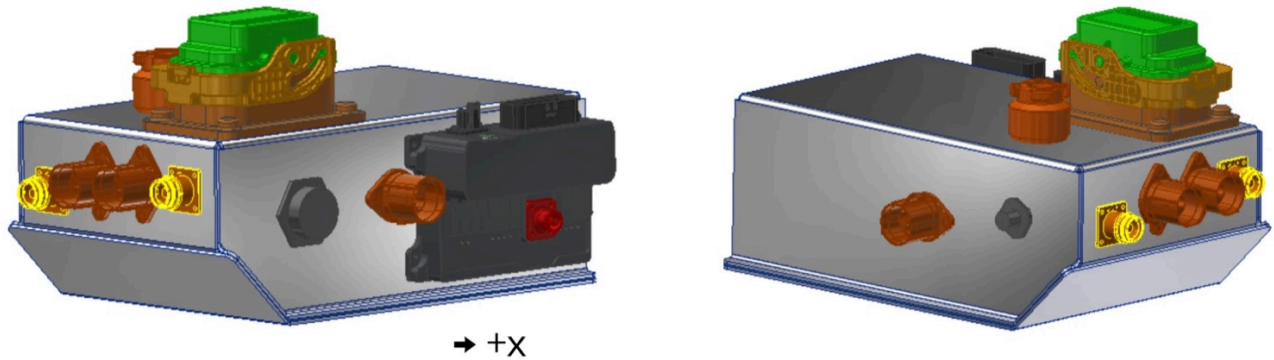
current dimensions:

13.5"x10"x5"

Cornell
Racing

FIGURE 10 ARG27 inverter enclosure design, current dimensions $13.5 \times 10 \times 5$ in.

Design



Cornell
Racing

FIGURE 11 ARG27 inverter enclosure design, with +x marked.

Accumulator Weight Targets							
Component	Current Wt. on ARG26 [kg]	ARG25 Wt. [kg]	Target Weight for ARG26 [kg]	TARGET ARG26 Wt. to ARG26 Wt. Delta [kg]	ARG25 to TARGET ARG26 Wt. Delta [kg]	ARG25 to CURRENT ARG26 Wt. Delta [kg]	Notes
Lower Case	8.680	7.801	4.000	4.680	-3.801	0.879	
Case Lid	0.000	1.860	1.000	-1.000	-0.860	-1.860	
Segments	34.500	37.013	37.000	-2.500	-0.013	-2.513	
Acc Electronics	2.523	2.495	2.200	0.323	-0.295	0.028	
Maintenance Plugs	0.563	1.000	0.800	-0.237	-0.200	-0.437	
TOTAL	46.266	50.169	45.000	1.266	-5.169	-3.903	

FIGURE 12 ARG26 weight budget, accumulator weight targets.

Powertrain Peripherals Weight Targets							
Component	Current Wt. on ARG26 [kg]	ARG25 Wt. [kg]	Target Weight for ARG26 [kg]	TARGET ARG26 Wt. to ARG26 Wt. Delta [kg]	ARG25 to TARGET ARG26 Wt. Delta [kg]	ARG25 to CURRENT ARG26 Wt. Delta [kg]	Notes
Inverters	15.500	15.513	14.000	1.500	-1.513	-0.013	enclosure with inverters, connectors, and current shunt
Radiators	2.500	2.500	2.300	0.200	-0.200	0.000	2x 1.25kg radiators
Radiator Fans	1.640	1.500	1.300	0.340	-0.200	0.140	2x 0.83kg fan
Cooling Lines and Fittings	1.580	4.000	3.500	-1.920	-0.500	-2.420	
Pump	1.996	1.500	1.350	0.646	-0.150	0.496	2x 2.2lb pumps
Catch Can	0.050	0.050	0.050	0.000	0.000	0.000	
Non-acc HVD		0.150	0.150	0.000	0.000	-0.150	
HV Cables	2.506	3.000	2.700	-0.194	-0.300	-0.494	
Water	1.424	2.000	2.000	-0.576	0.000	-0.576	.824L (motor/inv. loop tubing) +2(rad water vol (aprox .3L) + 4(sleeve
LV Box	0.340	0.267	0.250	0.090	-0.017	0.073	including telemetry
Nickel Paint	0.100	0.500	0.500	-0.400	0.000	-0.400	
Harness	3.500	4.540	4.400	-0.900	-0.140	-1.040	
Control Panel	0.601	0.584	0.400	0.201	-0.184	0.017	
Dashboard	0.178	0.500	0.400	-0.222	-0.100	-0.322	
TOTAL	31.915	36.604	33.300	-1.013	-3.304	-4.689	

FIGURE 13 ARG26 weight budget, powertrain peripherals weight targets.

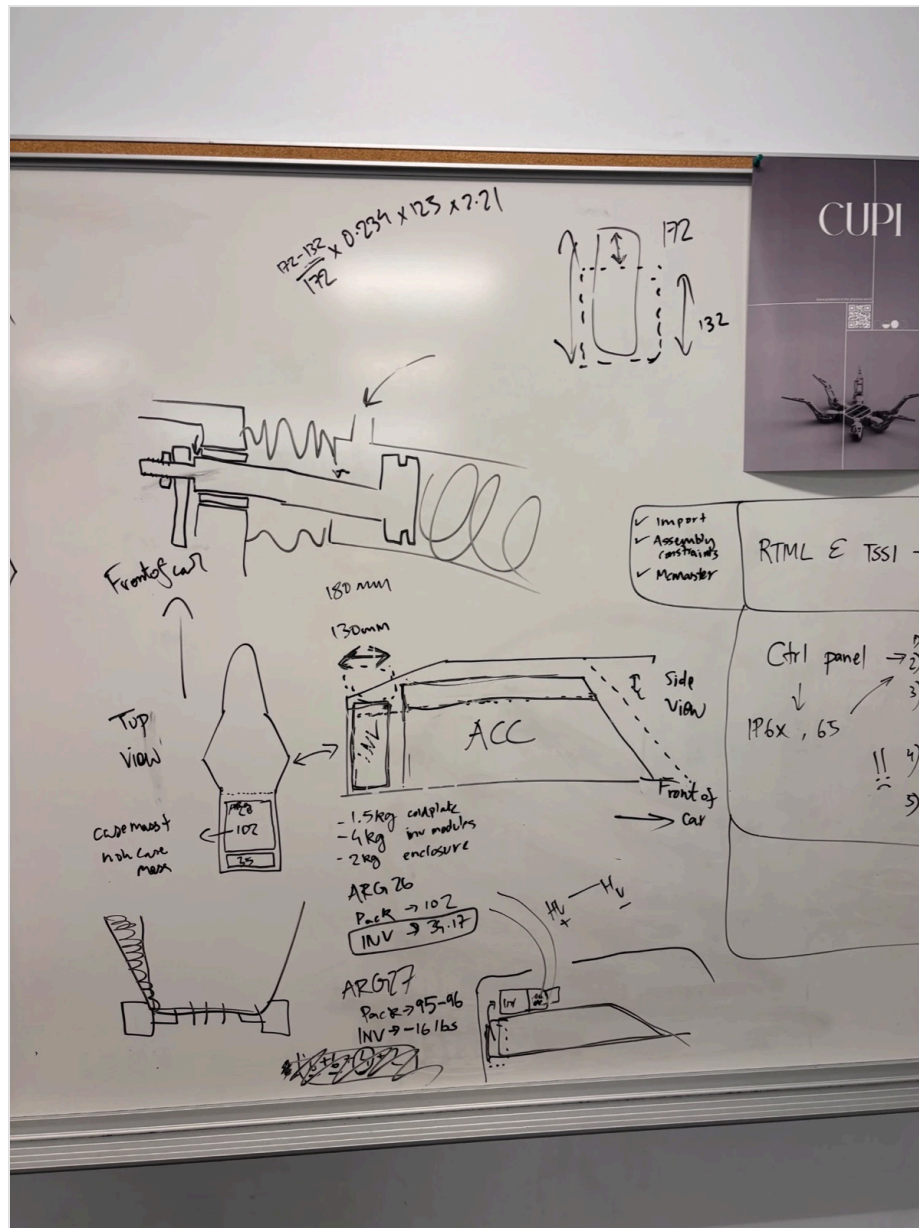


FIGURE 14 Whiteboard sketches mapping out the initial work on the accumulator and inverter changes.

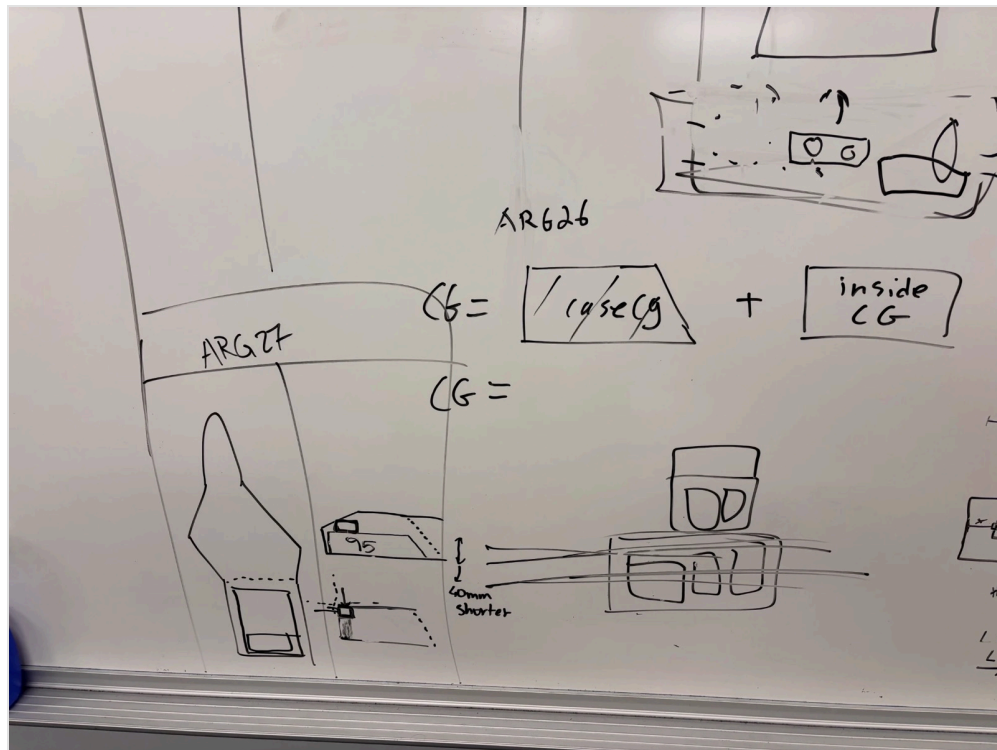


FIGURE 15 Whiteboard sketches comparing the ARG26 and ARG27 accumulator layouts.